

10.2. Include

‘Server Side Includes’ are used to create functions, headers, footers and certain other elements which can be reused on multiple pages. You can insert file content into a PHP file by using either the `include()` or `require()` function. Both the `include()` and `require()` functions are identical. The only difference lies in the way they handle errors. While the `include()` function generates a warning, the `require()` function generates a fatal error.

This feature of ‘include’ is beneficial on the part of the developer, as it saves considerable amount of time. You can also create a standard header or menu file to include in all web pages. If you want to update the header, simply update one include file. You can also change the menu file to add a new page to your site.

Suppose you have a standard PHP file named “firstpage.php”. You can include this file in a page by using the example below:

Example:

```
firstpage.php
<?php
$name = "John";
$address = "kolkata";
?>

secondpage.php
<?php
include("firstpage.php");
echo "Your name is ".$name." and you live in
".$address;
?>
```

In the above example, the “firstpage.php” file with all its contents is included in “secondpage.php”. To use a standard menu file in all pages, you can use the `include()` function. Let the code for creating menu be written in a file named “menu.php”. Now you have to include this file in all the pages using `include()` function.

require():

When a file is included with the `include()` function, it returns an error message as shown in the following example:

Example:

```
<html>
<body>
```